

JOMAR HESTER, MAcct, MSDS

CONTROLLER — MULTI-STATE CANNABIS OPERATIONS FINANCE

Cannabis Accounting | Internal Controls | Audit Management | Budgeting | Payroll | 280E Compliance | NetSuite

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Controller with 20+ years of accounting leadership, including seven years as Financial Controller at three vertically integrated cannabis operators (cultivation, manufacturing, distribution, retail) — the industry-senior profile this role calls for. Own the posting's core disciplines: month-end and quarterly close producing US GAAP-compliant statements; internal controls and safeguards over revenue, costs, and budgets; annual audit management as primary liaison to external auditors (PBC schedules); federal, state, and local tax compliance with 280E-aware cost accounting; budgeting with scheduling, analysis, and corrective actions; payroll efficiency; and financial-status reporting for senior managers.

TARGETED FIT FOR CONTROLLER — CONNECTED CANNABIS CO.

Cannabis industry, senior-level: Seven years as Financial Controller in cannabis: Terrapin Care Station (2013–2017, multi-state vertically integrated), Origin House (2018–2019, multiple California entities), Eel River Organics (2019–2020, regulated startup) — full-cycle accounting, reporting, budgeting, cash management, and tax compliance: the industry-senior background the posting describes.

Annual audit & tax compliance: Managed audit-ready workpapers and served as liaison with external auditors and CPAs; directed federal, state, and local tax compliance; built manufacturing and job-costing methodologies with documentation strong enough to cut tax liability by approximately \$880,000 — the 280E-aware cost discipline a cannabis controller needs.

Controls, budgeting & operational reporting: Developed, implemented, and maintained financial controls and guidelines; built internal safeguards for revenue, costs, and budgets vs. actuals; established financial and operating benchmarks with biweekly, monthly, and annual reporting; delivered financial-status reports and budget-to-actual analysis with corrective actions for senior managers.

Team leadership & payroll: Supervised accounting personnel with dynamic leadership built on trust and productivity; oversaw payroll accounting and streamlined payroll processes; partnered with directors on cash planning, cost control, and operational strategy.

SYSTEMS, DATA & AUTOMATION

QuickBooks Online/Desktop | NetSuite | SAP | Oracle | Bill.com | Ramp | ADP | Gusto | Advanced Excel | Power Query | Power BI | Python | SQL | ETL/ELT Pipelines | Financial Data Reconciliation | Reporting Automation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder & Accounting Consultant | Sensei Advisors LLC | Concurrent Consulting Practice | 2010 – Present

- Provide project-based and recurring accounting support to privately held companies, startups, and growing businesses, combining hands-on accounting execution with Controller-level review, owner advisory, and process improvement.
- Review and manage financial statements, general ledger activity, cash, AP, AR, billing, payroll accounting, journal entries, accruals, fixed assets, month-end close, budgets, cash forecasts, and financial models.
- Build close schedules, reconciliation templates, accounting procedures, approval workflows, issue logs, and management-reporting packages that improve consistency, accountability, and decision usefulness.
- Work directly with owners, executives, existing bookkeepers, outside CPAs, payroll providers, banks, and operating teams to resolve accounting issues while preserving documentation and audit trails.
- Apply QuickBooks, advanced Excel, Power Query, source data tie-outs, data reconciliation, and financial automation to reduce manual processing and improve reporting accuracy and timeliness.

Accounting Manager | Phylos Bioscience Inc. — Biotech Research | Portland, OR | Aug 2024 – Mar 2026

- Managed multi-entity accounting operations and month-end close, including journal entries, accruals, balance-sheet reconciliations, fixed assets, prepaids, payroll-related accounts, inventory, and intercompany activity.
- Prepared reconciliation workpapers and supporting schedules, investigated discrepancies, and strengthened accounting accuracy, documentation, internal controls, and audit readiness.
- Partnered with leadership and operational stakeholders to align accounting data with inventory valuation, R&D spending, SG&A analysis, cash activity, and management-reporting requirements.
- Used QuickBooks Online, Bill.com, ADP, Gusto, Prendio, Chase, Vanguard, Asset Tiger, and advanced Excel in a lean accounting environment requiring ownership and reliable close execution.

Accounting Manager | ASM Global | Oakland Arena & Oakland Stadium | Oakland, CA | Jan 2023 – Aug 2024

- Oversaw general ledger, cash, AP, AR, payroll, bank reconciliations, month-end close, and financial reporting for high-volume venue operations.
- Managed event settlements, contract review, revenue recognition, cash-control processes, budgets, forecasts, variance analysis, and audit-ready workpapers for executive and operational leaders.
- Coordinated cross-functionally with operations and finance stakeholders to resolve accounting inquiries, improve reporting visibility, and maintain close discipline.

CONTROLLER LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Financial Controller | Eel River Organics | Arcata, CA | Jun 2019 – Jan 2020

- Directed full-cycle accounting, financial reporting, tax compliance, budgeting, cost accounting, inventory controls, and operational finance for a regulated startup environment.
- Built internal controls, accounting procedures, and documentation for inventory, production, financial reporting, and tax-compliance workflows; partnered with directors on cash planning and cost control.
- Developed manufacturing and job-costing methodologies that improved cost accuracy and supporting documentation while reducing tax liability by approximately \$880,000.

Financial Controller | Origin House (ORHOF) | San Francisco Bay Area, CA | Feb 2018 – Jun 2019

- Directed accounting, financial reporting, planning, budgeting, and tax compliance for a company operating through multiple California entities.
- Prepared monthly financial statements, account reconciliations, tax-support schedules, and audit documentation; supported operations through cost accounting, inventory controls, and pricing variance analysis.
- Developed financial models and reporting processes using historical and operational data while strengthening internal controls over manufacturing work-in-progress.

Financial Controller | Renaissance Solutions Inc. DBA Terrapin Care Station | Boulder, CO | Mar 2013 – Dec 2017

- Led accounting, financial reporting, planning, budgeting, cash management, and tax compliance for a multi-state, vertically integrated operating company.
- Managed capital project and facility build-out accounting support, budget-to-actual tracking, vendor activity, cash planning, and operational cost reporting.
- Supervised accounting personnel, supported process documentation, strengthened financial controls, and prepared management reporting for ownership and operating leaders.

PUBLIC COMPANY & EARLIER ACCOUNTING EXPERIENCE

Corporate Accountant | Denver Westwood | Denver, CO | Jun 2012 – Mar 2013

- Supported month-, quarter-, and year-end close, US GAAP reporting, general-ledger and intercompany accounting, account reconciliations, SEC 10-Q and 11-K reporting, SOX controls, external audits, and GAAP/FASB research for a public multinational manufacturer.

Corporate Accountant | Multi-Color Corporation (LABL) | Cincinnati, OH | May 2007 – Jan 2012

- Supported general-ledger accounting, close, customer invoicing, payment processing, bank and credit-card reconciliations, variance analysis, operating metrics, and financial reporting.

Tax Associate | Grant Thornton LLP | Cincinnati, OH | Jan 2005 – May 2007

- Prepared federal, state, and local tax returns and supporting workpapers for corporations, partnerships, and real-estate entities.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Data Science | Stanford University | 2026**Master of Science in Accounting | University of Cincinnati | 2007****Bachelor of Business Administration in Accounting | University of Cincinnati | 2005**